countries which may entertain such notions. With Agni, India had reached the stage where she had the option of preventing wars involving her.

Agni marked the completion of five years of IGMDP. Now that it had demonstrated our competence in the crucial area of re-entry technology and with tactical missiles like Prithvi and Trishul already testfired, the launches of Nag and Akash would take us into areas of competence where there is little or no international competition. These two missile systems contained within themselves the stuff of major technological breakthroughs. There was a need to focus our efforts more intensively on them.

In September 1989, I was invited by the Maharashtra Academy of Sciences in Bombay to deliver the Jawaharlal Nehru Memorial Lecture. I used this opportunity to share with the budding scientists my plans of making an indigenous Air-to-Air missile, Astra. It would dovetail with the development of the Indian Light Combat Aircraft (LCA). I told them that our work in Imaging Infra Red (I R) and Mil imetric Wave (MMW) radar technology for the Nag missile system had placed us in the vanguard of international R&D efforts in missile technology. I also drew